Sunday John OLUWADERO. Ph.D.

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Education and Social Policy, 2026
University of Delaware.

Dissertation Title: Concerted Resilience: Integrative Policy Approaches for Enhancing Food Security and Inclusive Livelihood Transformation in a Post-Aid World.

Dissertation Committee Members: Dr. Allison Karypn (*Chair),* Dr. Sarah Bruch, Dr. Melisa Melby, and Dr. Erecia Hepburn.

Master of Arts (MA), Education and Social Policy, 2024
University of Delaware

Graduate Certificate in Program Evaluation - Interdisciplinary Evaluation Science 2024
University of Delaware

Bachelor of Pharmacy (B.Pharm), 2015
University of Ibadan, Nigeria.

AREA OF SPECIALIZATION:

Community wellbeing and social policy | Participatory and community engaged research | Social protection and resilience governance | Health equity and social determinants of health | Program evaluation and policy analysis | Youth development and civic engagement

RESEARCH METHODS

Causal inference and quasi-experimental methods (Difference-in-Differences, matched designs) | Impact evaluation using longitudinal and survey data | Mixed methods research design | Participatory and qualitative research (lived experience, stakeholder interviews) | Quantitative analysis (Stata, R) | Data visualisation | Program evaluation and policy analysis | Knowledge mobilisation and stakeholder engagement.

PUBLICATIONS

Oluwadero, J. (2026). Closing the Hunger Gap: Can Integrated Social Protection Systems Improve Food Security Outcomes for Rural Households? A Causal Impact Evaluation [Submitted to University of Delaware Graduate College. Available on ProQuest].

Oluwadero, J. (2026). Closing the Poverty Gap: Does Integrated Social Protection Foster Inclusive Rural Transformation? A Causal Analysis of Livelihood Diversification Among Vulnerable Households [Submitted to University of Delaware Graduate College. Available on ProQuest].

Oluwadero, J. (2026). Concerted Resilience: A Governance Approach to Integrating Social Protection, Local Institutions, and Policy Systems for Transformative Resilience [Submitted to University of Delaware Graduate College. Available on ProQuest].

Axe, M., McCallops, K., **Oluwadero, J.,** & Karpyn, A. (2025). The Delaware Food Farmacy: Integrating medically tailored groceries and community health workers into chronic disease management. Delaware Journal of Public Health. November 2025 https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12671583/

Oluwadero, **J**., De Leon, L., Falgowski, M., Holman, E., Kennedy, N., Norris-Bent, M., Patosky, H., Richardson, R., Seibold, M., Tracy, T., & Karpyn, A. (2025). Food is medicine: The effectiveness of Delaware's Feeding Families Program in managing chronic conditions. Delaware Journal of Public Health. 2025 Apr 30;11(1):10–18. https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12051899/

Karpyn, A., Kennedy, N., Seibold, M., Tracy, T., Kim, J., Larock, J., Silberg, T., Lennon, J., **Oluwadero, J**., & Ratnayake, M. (2024). Understanding benefits of a college student-homebound adult partnership program to support aging in place: An exploratory study. Evaluation and Program Planning, 106, 102464. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.evalprogplan.2024.102464

Erecia H, Allison K, **Oluwadero** S.J. (2024). Analysis of Changing Food Prices in New Providence, Bahamas 2017-2023. Farm and Business - The Journal of the Caribbean Agro-Economic Society. https://doi.org/10.22004/ag.econ.348843

IN-PROGRESS

Oluwadero J., Gradjansky I., Kennedy N., & Karpyn, A. (Under Review 2025). From Participants to Partners: Alumni Engagement in Nonprofit Program Planning [Manuscript under review, 2025].

Oluwadero, J & Karpyn, A. Flood Resilience Planning in Smallholder Farmers Communities in Nigeria: A Policy Assessment. [Manuscript under review, 2025].

Oluwadero, J & Karpyn, A. Resilient Social Protection in the Era of Declining Aid: The Case for Integrating Formal and Informal Systems [Under Review, 2025].

Whitaker, A, & **Oluwadero, J.** (2025, November). The Cost of Compliance: Exploring Policy Alignment and Administrative Burden in Early Care and Education. [Manuscript in progress, 2025].

PROGRAM EVALUATION REPORTS AND POLICY BRIEFS

Karpyn, A., Halverson, M., **Oluwadero, J**., Wallace, J. (2023). "Integrating Lori's Hands into Home-Based Primary Care Services to Support Food Security and General Independence Among Individuals with Chronic Illness: Final Program Report". Center for Research in Education and Social Policy, University of Delaware. https://lorishands.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/10/CRESP-Final-Report_Loris-Hands-PCaH-Pilot.pdf

Karpyn, A., Bulger, L., **Oluwadero**, **J**., Seibold, M., & Halverson, M. M. (2023). Evaluation of the SevaTruck Foundation's After-School Healthy Meals Program. Center for Research in Education and Social Policy. https://www.cresp.udel.edu/wp-content/uploads/2023/06/SevaTruck-Final-Report.pdf

Karpyn, A., Kennedy, N., Halverson, M. M., **Oluwadero**, **J**., & Finneran, B. (2023). 4.0 Fund III Annual Evaluation: 2023. Center for Research in Education and Social Policy.

Karpyn, A., Appel, E., **Oluwadero, J.,** & Kennedy, N. (May 2025). 2025 4.0 Alumni Survey: Final Report (T25-012). Newark, DE: Center for Research in Education and Social Policy. https://www.4pt0.org/post/alumni-survey-2025

RESEARCH/POLICY BRIEFS AND REPORTS

Karpyn, A., Appel, E**., Oluwadero, J**., & Kennedy, N. and Dakko, G. (June 2025). 2025 Impact Brief: 4.0 Schools (T25-011). Newark, DE: Center for Research in Education and Social Policy.

Oluwadero, J., Kennedy, N., Gradjansky, I. & Karpyn, A. (June, 2025). 4.0 IMPACT BRIEF (PB25-001). Newark, DE: Center for Research in Education and Social Policy.

Karpyn, A., **Oluwadero, J.** (May 2024). Evidence of the Relationship between School Meals Participation and Child Outcomes. Newark, DE: Center for Research in Education and Social Policy https://www.cresp.udel.edu/schoolmealsparticipation/

Oluwadero, J. & Ndoh O (June 2023). Project RECOVER - Enabling livelihood recovery of smallholding farmers in flood-affected communities in Ibaji LGA, Kogi State, Nigeria. Ibadan, Nigeria: Building Nations Initiative (BNI https://projectrecover.bniglobal.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/11/ProjectRECOVER-Update.pdf

Oluwadero, J. Research Brief: Assessment of Policy Approaches to Flood Disaster Management in Nigeria. https://projectrecover.bniglobal.org/research/

Oluwadero, J. Adebola P., Ibiwoye V., Nwafor J. Ndoh, O. & Ojo E. (May 2019). The Role of Youth-Led Organizations in Political Participation and Peaceful Elections. Abuja, Nigeria: UNESCO Regional Office, Abuja.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Paper Presentation

Oluwadero, S.J. (2026, July). *Decolonising Social Protection in a Post-Aid World: Implications for Inclusive Livelihood Transformation*. 2026 Annual Conference, Social Policy Association. Liverpool, United Kingdom. *Accepted Individual Presentation*

Oluwadero, S.J. (2025, November). *Concerted Resilience: Integrative Policy Approaches for Enhancing Global Food Security in a Post-Aid World.* 2025 Conference, Association for Research in Non-Profit and Voluntary Actions (ARNOVA). Indianapolis, Indiana.

Oluwadero, S.J. (2025, November). *Closing the Hunger Gap: Can Integrated Social Protection Systems Improve Food Security Outcomes for Rural Households? A Causal Impact Evaluation.* 2025 Association of Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference. Seattle, Washington.

Oluwadero, S.J. & Karpyn, A. (2024, June). *Through Their Lens: Using Photovoice to Explore Youth Contributions to Addressing Food Insecurity and Climate Change in Africa.* 2024 Canada Association of African Studies Conference, McGill University, Montreal, Canada.

Oluwadero, S.J, & Karpyn, A. (2024, May). *Assessment of Policy Approaches to Flood Disaster Management in Coastal Farming Communities in Nigeria.* 2024 Cross University Collaborative Mentoring Conference, New York, NY. https://projectrecover.bniglobal.org/research/

Oluwadero, S.J, & Karpyn, A. (2023, November). *Flood Resilience Planning in Smallholder Farmers Communities in Nigeria: A Policy Assessment.* Conference on Land Policy in Africa, organized by the African Land Policy Centre, a joint initiative of the United Nations Economic Commission for Africa (ECA), the African Union Commission (AUC), and the African Development Bank.

Erecia H, Allison K, **Oluwadero** S.J. (2023, June). *Documenting Changing Food Prices in New Providence, Bahamas 2017-2023*. A conference paper presented at the 34th West Indies Agricultural Economics Conference, Nassau, Bahamas.

Poster Presentation

Oluwadero, S.J, & Karpyn, A. (2024, April). *Assessment of Policy Responses to Flood-Induced Food Insecurity in Nigeria.* M.H. Steele Research Symposium, School of Education and the Department of Human Development and Family Sciences, University of Delaware, Newark, DE.

Oluwadero, S.J, & Karpyn, A. (2024, March). *Multilayered Community-Based Participatory Research for Assessing Flood Impact in Smallholder Farmer Communities in Nigeria*. University of Delaware Provost Symposium, Newark, DE

Karpyn, A., Norris-Bent M., Holman E., De Leon L., Richardson R., Patosky H., Bryan D., Halverson M., **Oluwadero S.J.**, Van Horne S., & Kennedy N. (2024, March) *Feeding Delaware Families: Food is Medicine at Westside Family Healthcare*. University of Delaware Provost Symposium, Newark, DE

Panel Presentation

Panel Speaker (2024, September). *Implementing the Declaration of Future Generation in Africa and Beyond.* A side event organized by the School of International Futures at the 2024 United Nations Summit of the Future.

Halverson, M. M., Llana, K., **Oluwadero,** J., & Roders, V. (2025). Focusing on the basics: Housing and Food. Steele Symposium conference. Newark, DE.

Oluwadero, S.J. (2021, September). *Youth Opportunities in Sports Manufacturing and the African Continental Free Trade Agreement AfCTA.* A panel presentation at a seminar organized by the United Nations Economic Commission for Africa, in partnership with the African Trade Policy Centre (ATPC), and African Sports Unified.

HONORS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

First Place, Community Choice Award, Community Engaged Research October 2025
Delaware Clinical and Translational Research – ACCEL
Study: Oluwadero et al. (2025); Food is medicine: The effectiveness of Delaware's Feeding Families Program in managing chronic conditions

University of Delaware Doctoral Fellowship for Excellence 2025-2026
Funding Award: $35,167, full tuition scholarship

University of Delaware Graduate Travel Award 2024-2025
Funding Award: $267; $1477; $654

Best Graduate Student Poster Award 2024
University of Delaware Steele Symposium
Prize Award: $500

Fellow, Innocent Chukwuma Social Impact Chair and Fellowship 2022
Lagos Business School, Pan Atlantic University, Lagos, Nigeria.
Funding Award: $3000 *(Supported by Ford Foundation)*

UNESCO Youth Civic Engagement Initiative (Research Grant) 2019
Funding Award: $2500

Youth Leadership and Governance Award 2021
United Nations Development Program UNDP Nigeria.
Full travel fund ($1500) to attend Youth Connekt Africa Summit, Accra, Ghana

Ten Outstanding Young Persons in Nigeria 2018
Junior Chamber International (JCI) Nigeria National Award

Associate Fellow, 2018
Royal Commonwealth Society (RCS), United Kingdom

Building Bridges Research Fellowship 2018
Nelson Mandela School of Public Governance,
University of Cape Town.

Fellow, Emerging African Leaders Program 2018
Nelson Mandela School of Public Governance,
University of Cape Town.

Full Delegate Scholarship, Commonwealth Secretariat 2018
Full travel award to attend Youth Forum, Commonwealth Heads of Government Meeting (CHOGM), London, United Kingdom. Hosted by the Commonwealth Secretariat in partnership with the UK Government

Full Delegate Scholarship, Commonwealth Secretariat/Government of Uganda 2017
Full travel award to attend the 9th Commonwealth Youth Ministers Meeting, Kampala, Uganda.

Fellow, USAID Young African Leaders Initiative (YALI) 2016
West Africa Regional Leadership Center,
Ghana Institute for Management and Public Administration (GIMPA)

Finalist, Queen's Young Leaders Award. 2015
Queen Elizabeth Diamond Jubilee Trust

Full Delegate Scholarship, United Nations/Government of Sri Lanka 2014
Full travel award as National Youth Delegate (Nigeria) to attend the United Nations World Conference on Youth, Colombo, Sri Lanka.

Travel Scholarship, Ekiti State Government 2013
Full travel funding Award: N350,000 to attend the Commonwealth Conference on Education and Training of Youth Workers, University of South Africa, Pretoria. Hosted by the Government of the Republic of South Africa and the Commonwealth Secretariat

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Research Fellow 2025-Present
Center for Research in Education and Social Policy, University of Delaware.
Advisor: Dr. Allison Karpyn, Professor and Co-Director, Center for Research in Education and Social Policy, University of Delaware.

- Advance knowledge management for the Food is Medicine / Food Stigma Lab by drafting research briefs and presentations and sharing findings with community and practitioner audiences.

- Supported the evaluation of an intergenerational student–homebound adult partnership program that connects homebound adults with college students in Delaware.
- Collaborated with PI and a 6-member research team to evaluate seven grant-funded projects over two years; built Qualtrics surveys, managed data collection, cleaned and analyzed datasets in R and Stata, and built Excel/Power BI dashboards that surfaced actionable insights adopted by six partner organizations.

Research Assistant 2022-2024
Center for Research in Education and Social Policy, University of Delaware.
Advisor: Dr. Allison Karpyn, Professor and Co-Director, Center for Research in Education and Social Policy, University of Delaware.

Research Assistant Fall 2024-Spring 2025
Principal Investigator: Dr. Elizabeth Farley-Ripple, Professor and Director of the Partnership for Public Education, University of Delaware.
Title of Project: *A Critical, Ecological Perspective on the Wallace Foundation Research Production, Diffusion, and Use.*

Research Assistant Summer 2024-Spring 2025
Principal Investigator: Dr. Annemarie Whitaker. Department of Human Development and Family Sciences at the University of Delaware.
Title of Project: *A Mixed Methods Approach to Understanding Perceptions of Early Care and Education Policy Alignment Within State Early Learning Systems*

Lead Researcher 2018-2019
UNESCO Youth Civic Engagement Initiative, Nigeria Country Team

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

President 2023-2024
Black Graduate Student Association, University of Delaware

- Led initiatives supporting Black graduate student wellbeing, belonging, and leadership development, organizing 12 programs during the 2023–2024 academic year with an average of 42 participants per event (peak 72), engaging 312 students and community members.
- Established partnerships with the Graduate College, Center for Black Culture, Center for Wellbeing, Center for Intercultural Engagement, and the African Graduate Student Organization through the creation of a BGSA–AGSO Representative role, resulting in six co-sponsored programs and $3,600 in institutional support.
- Coordinated wellbeing-focused initiatives including a campus Wellbeing Fair to address barriers to mental health resource access among Black graduate students and to foster dialogue around belonging and institutional support.
- Expanded community engagement through partnerships with the Delaware African Coalition, mobilizing volunteers for events such as the Mandela Washington Fellowship Dinner and the Delaware African Coalition Annual Symposium.
- Organized and produced the 2024 BGSA Leadership Symposium and Awards Ceremony, convening 72 students, alumni, and community members to celebrate leadership and strengthen networks of support.

External Consultant (Research and Policy Analysis) 2023–Present
Gender Mobile Initiative (Nigeria)

- Support the design and implementation of research examining structural barriers affecting women and marginalized communities.
- Produce policy briefs, research summaries, and stakeholder reports translating evidence into actionable recommendations for nonprofit and public sector partners
- Supports advocacy, design, and adoption of anti-sexual harassment policies across tertiary institution campuses in Nigeria.

Regional Coordinator for Africa (Literacy) 2020-2022
Royal Commonwealth Society, United Kingdom

Executive Director 2019-2022
Building Nations Initiative (BNI)

- Set and executed multi-year operational plans aligned to strategy; oversaw multi-site delivery across 3 youth centers, ensuring quality, safety, and on-time logistics for 26+ events and 14 outreaches.
- Hired, coached, and performance-managed staff/volunteers (12 staff, 80+ volunteers); established clear KPIs and program dashboards tied to beneficiary outcomes.

Public Health Pharmacist, 2018-2019
Oyo State Ministry of Health, Ibadan, Nigeria
Africa Regional Representative 2016-2017
Commonwealth Youth Sport for Development and Peace Working Group (CYSDP),
Commonwealth Youth Programme, Commonwealth Secretariat.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Human Subject Protection Certification 2025
Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative (CITI),
Under requirements set by the University of Delaware.

Certificate of Completion in Systems Change 2019
American Express/Ashoka Leadership Academy,
Nairobi, Kenya.

Emerging African Leaders Program 2018
The Nelson Mandela School of Public Governance, University of Cape Town, South Africa

CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOP PARTICIPATION

- 2024 Association of Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference, Maryland, United States, November 21 - 23, 2024.
- 2024 United Nations Summit of the Future, New York City, United States. 20th-22nd September 2024
- Fifth Conference on Land Policy in Africa, organized by the African Land Policy Centre, a joint initiative of the United Nations Economic Commission for Africa (ECA), the African Union Commission (AUC), and the African Development Bank. 21-24 November, 2023.
- United Nations Transforming Education Summit, United Nations Headquarters, New York 16th-19th September 2022
- Ashoka Emerging Innovators Bootcamp, Nairobi, Kenya. 29th October- 1st November 2019
- Building Bridges Research Round-table, The Nelson Mandela School of Public Governance, University of Cape Town South Africa 12th-15th September 2018.
- World Bank Group Youth Forum, Abdijan, Cote D'Ivoire.(May 2015)

AFFILIATIONS & MEMBERSHIPS

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management 2021 – Present
Association for Research on Nonprofit Organizations and Voluntary Action (ARNOVA) 2025 - Present
Social Policy Association 2026 - Present